CHAPTER 01 | AROUND 2000-2007: FIVE DAY-SCHOOL YEARS, THEN TWO BOARDING HIGH-SCHOOL YEARS

Fiango

Football, friendship, unpaid school fees, and a gifted boy's growing determination to give his mother a better life.

Dramatic question What happens when a boy who can invent a solution to anything meets a problem he cannot talk his way out of?

Act I - Setup

Street football introduces Zino's wit, competitiveness, and temper. Luc and Gideon hear his outrageous stories about Grand-Chukuchuku, the man who achieves what nobody else can. Brief fantasy sequences make those boasts visible before returning us to the real game. The compound is a small society: two families, three single mothers, two bachelors, and three student tenants share the well and mango tree. The landlord's monthly collection of rent and electricity money turns money into a recurring presence. Zino's mother, a primary-school teacher, believes in him. His father died after a snake bite while spraying cocoa when Zino was two, so the loss enters through family history rather than a memory he owns.

Turning point: His imagination can win an argument, but the household's limits cannot be wished away.

Act II - Confrontation

The first five years of day school give Zino daily life with Luc and Gideon. His earlier primary-school fee exclusion can return as a clearly placed memory; the later high-school exclusion belongs at its actual date. Each June, the daytime vocational school called Professional School opens classrooms at night for day-school students to revise, study in groups, socialize, or escape home; show its temptations without claiming every student is distracted. Zino's four reported encounters with jungle justice occur during these Fiango years. The final two high-school years move him to a remote village reached after a day of travel through mountains and valleys. Boarding school brings elite students, rich parents, white teachers and priests, rigid routine, bullying, and discipline. Zino witnesses students punished for jumping the fence to buy food; he is not the student jumping.

Turning point: Being clever does not make Zino safe when the rules, people, and distance from home all change.

Act III - Consequence

Zino completes secondary school in 2007. Academic progress creates a new threshold rather than financial security. The closing movement should grow from a remembered examination, result, or family conversation, making clear what this achievement means to him and his mother. Grand-Chukuchuku can still supply effortless victories; Zino's real future requires help, patience, and choices. The child who dreams of lifting his mother out of hardship now faces the practical requirements of further education. The chapter ends with a milestone achieved and the next opportunity still uncertain.

Turning point: He has the ability to continue, but the household still needs a way to pay.

CHAPTER 01 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

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Fiango

At the beginning	At ten, Zino has completed primary school and lives with his mother in Fiango.
At the end	Secondary school is complete in 2007; his ambition now depends on finding a way to continue.

Three possible short episodes

1. Grand-Chukuchuku Never Loses

A football dispute introduces the imaginary hero and the real boy's difficulty accepting an unfavorable decision.

2. School Fees

At the remembered age, a fee exclusion interrupts academic confidence and changes the rhythm of an ordinary school day.

3. The Crowd

Zino witnesses a hard-R composite of jungle justice during the Fiango day-school years: an accusation becomes public violence. The episode shows the brutality directly and ends with the fear, silence, and moral damage left behind.

4. The Long Road

A day-long trip through mountains and valleys takes Zino to boarding school, where distance, wealth, routine, bullying, and strict discipline change the rules of his life.

5. The Fence

Zino witnesses students punished after jumping the boarding-school fence to buy food. The episode makes clear that he does not jump, while showing how hunger, fear, and discipline shape the whole dormitory.

Memory prompts

1. Which day school did you attend with Luc and Gideon, when did boarding begin, and what is one defining memory of Luc, Gideon, Elianne, or Miss Mukete?

2. Who told you the story of your father's death, and what details are most important for that family-history scene?

3. What did Professional School mean in your day school, which exam was it for, and what is one evening or jungle-justice incident you remember most clearly?

4. What was the boarding school's name, how did you travel there, and what did the mountains, valleys, dormitories, teachers, priests, bullying, and punishment feel like?

Grand-Chukuchuku motif Grand-Chukuchuku is playful and spectacular: imaginary victories contrast with ordinary limits.

Details still open: The first five years are Fiango day school with Luc and Gideon; the final two are remote boarding high school. Professional School belongs in day school. Zino witnessed, rather than joined, the fence punishments.